



US Hwy 169 Corridor Coalition

Working together to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development along the US Highway169 inter-regional corridor.

Board Meeting Minutes

September 10, 2015

7:00 p.m. – 9:00 p.m.

Location: Scott County Government Center

First Name	Last Name	Title	Agency
Bob	Broeder	Mayor	City of LeSueur
Andrew	Carlson	Council Member	City of Bloomington
Lisa	Freese	Transportation Program Director	Scott County
Jim	Gates	Deputy Director of Public Works	City of Bloomington
Peter	Harff	Project Manager	MnDOT
Jim	Hovland	Mayor	City of Edina
John	Schmitt	Former Mayor	City of Shakopee
Vance	Stuehrenberg	Commissioner	Blue Earth County
Alan	Forsberg	County Engineer	Blue Earth County
Mark	Fuhrmann	Deputy General Manager	Metropolitan Council
Andrew	Lutaya	Project Manager	MnDOT
Jon	Powell	Public Works Director	City of Belle Paine
Pete	Moulton	Public Works Director	City of Saint Peter
Gene	Abbott	Council Member	City of Savage
Ashley	Ver Burg	Communications Specialist	HDR

1. Welcome/Introductions – Jon Ulrich, Chair, Scott County Commissioner

2. Presentation Updates

- Nine Mile Creek Bridge Replacement – Andrew Lutaya, MnDOT
 - o The year-long closure will be between Bren Road and 7th Street.
 - o The bridge replacement is a design-build job.
 - o The RFP is scheduled to go out April 15, 2016 with notice to proceed July 27, 2016, and construction to begin in fall 2016.
 - o Public engagement is occurring now, along with permitting.
 - o Project components include bridge replacement, pavement replacement, noise wall replacement, and ADA ramp addition.
 - o The decision was made to do a full closure because of the daily user costs. The full closure was the least impactful.

- o MnDOT is including a \$4 million premium in the construction budget to ensure it can be completed in 12 months.
 - o The future bridge could include a third MnPASS lane in the future.
 - o MnDOT is working toward allowing a causeway in design and construction.
 - o MnDOT is holding many meetings with public, employers, transit agencies, government groups, and others. Open houses will be held next week.
 - o There are a number of MnPASS Express Lane studies ongoing and upcoming, such as the 169 transitway study.
 - o Highway 100 will be opened prior to construction.
 - o The last exit for northbound traffic will be Bren Road.
 - o The last exit for southbound traffic will be the Lincoln Drive exit.
 - o MnDOT is working to identify those local routes, which will experience major traffic impacts and determine what can be done to discourage cut through routes. Strategies will be proposed based upon input from the public.
 - o The bridge width is being considered for a future MnPASS lane and/or transitway.
 - o Commissioner Stuehrenberg stated that MnDOT's cost determination should include cost of public safety and suggested reconsideration.
 - o Preferred detours will be I-494 and Highway 100.
- Southwest Light Rail Transit – Mark
 - o There are currently 22 miles of light rail in the region. There have been over 110 million riders on Blue Line since 2004. There have been \$3 billion worth of private investment along the METRO Green and Blue lines.
 - o The scope of the METRO Green Line Extension includes 14.5 miles of track, 15 new stations, 32 bridges, and 2 LRT tunnels.
 - o There will an estimated 34,000 average weekday riders in 2040.
 - o The scope was reduced by some non-essential features such as furnishings, station art, and landscaping.
 - o If private funding becomes available, there could be public art additions in the future.
 - o The scope change retains 94-percent of ridership, 90-percent of corridor length, and 96-percent of the jobs served in the corridor.
 - o The new terminal station will be the SouthWest Station transit hub.
 - o The second round of the municipal consent process will occur during September 2015.
 - o This is the largest public funding project in the state of Minnesota. Green Line was prior until the new Vikings stadium.

- o 2016 at the Legislature is the critical year for Southwest. The state commitment is required for the FTA to sign the full funding grant agreement. FTA is supportive of the project.
- o Metro Transit operates a cost-efficient system compared to peers. We recover between 35 and 40 cents on the dollar for operating light rail. State constitution does not allow highway state trust fund dollars for transit. Half of the cost comes from the Counties Transit Improvement Board and the other half comes from the state.
- o The Supplement Draft Environmental Impact Statement should be published next spring.
- o The current timeline shows construction between 2017 and 2019, with revenue service beginning in 2020.
- o This will be a 27-mile long line between Eden Prairie and Union Depot.
- o There are regular fare compliance checks at stations and on trains. Last year's fare evasion audit (using a 10 percent sample) showed 98 percent fare compliance.
- o 82 percent of the local funding has been committed.
- o The trip length from Southwest Station to Nicollet Mall station will be 39 minutes. This will be consistent.

3. Adoption of Agenda

Member Gates moved to adopt the agenda. Mayor Hovland seconded the motion. It was approved.

4. Adoption of Minutes

Commissioner Stuehrenberg moved to adopt the minutes. Council Member Abbott seconded the motion. It was approved.

5. Financial Report – August 2015

- The City of Mankato joined in August.
- A distribution was made to HDR for \$2,800.
- A distribution was made to the transitway study for \$25,000 for intercity bus portion of the study to Mankato.
- The balance is \$112,055.
- Mayor Hovland motioned to adopt the budget. Council Member Abbott seconded the motion. The budget was approved.

6. Transitway Study Update

- The study is kicking-off tomorrow, Friday, September 11.
- The consultant is SRF Consulting Group.
- It will be an 18-month study.

- There will be preliminary findings within a year.
- Any interested US 169 Corridor Coalition members who would like to be included on the study committees should contact Lisa Freese.

7. Regular Project Updates

- 169 Connector CMAQ – Scott County
 - o A CMAQ grant will fund new bus service within Scott County.
 - o The service will be balanced at 40 percent outbound (from Scott County to employment centers) and 60 percent inbound (back to Scott County).

8. LeSueur RCIC Project

- The project is 60-percent complete.

9. Upcoming Meeting

- Member Gates motioned to approve the schedule. Council Member Abbott seconded the motion. It was approved.

10. Other Items

- TED Grant
 - o Scott County will be requesting \$10 million for the US 169/TH 41/CH 78 interchange project.
 - o The project has already received funding through the regional solicitation, and there is a TIGER grant request currently under consideration.
 - o The planning-level cost estimate is \$32 million.
 - o Mayor Hovland moved to support the grant application. It was seconded by Mayor Broeder. The motion was approved.
- The southwest reconnection project will be completed in November. This will be on the agenda in November.

11. The meeting was adjourned at 8:22 pm.